Ford Motor Company

April 2001

TO: All Ford and Lincoln Mercury Dealers

SUBJECT: DEMONSTRATION / DELIVERY HOLD: Safety Recall 01S16 - Certain 2001 Model Year Taurus and Sable vehicles – Front Seat Belt Buckle Replacement

REF: Dealer Announcement dated May 10, 1999: Low Volume Recalls and Owner Notification Program (Attachment IV)

AFFECTED VEHICLES

Certain 2001 model year Taurus and Sable vehicles built at the Chicago Assembly Plant from January 30, 2001 through February 15, 2001. Also, certain 2001 model year Taurus and Sable vehicles built at the Atlanta Assembly Plant from January 26, 2001 through February 10, 2001.

SAFETY CONCERN

In some of the affected vehicles, the front seat belt buckles may not fully eject the tongue from the buckle assembly when the release button is depressed slowly. This condition can also potentially result in a partial latch of the tongue in the buckle. If this occurs, the seat belt could provide less than the intended level of occupant restraint in the event of a vehicle crash.

SERVICE ACTION

Before demonstrating or delivering any of the vehicles involved in this recall, the dealer must install a replacement driver side and passenger side front seat belt buckle.

PLEASE NOTE

Correct all vehicles in stock before delivery. Federal law requires dealers to complete any outstanding safety recall service before a new vehicle is delivered to the buyer or lessee. Violation of this requirement by a dealer could result in a civil penalty of up to $5,000 per vehicle.

LOW VOLUME RECALL

This program is being processed as a Low Volume Recall. This type of field action was announced in an All-Dealer letter dated May 10,1999 (see Attachment IV).

Owners will be contacting Program Headquarters to arrange for this service. We will advise you via MORS III of the owners that chose your dealership to perform the service provided by this Recall program. The parts will be ordered for you by Program Headquarters.

You are requested to contact the owner and arrange for this service. (Note that Program Headquarters will advise owners that they will hear from you within the next two business Days).

ATTACHMENTS

Attachment I: Administrative Information
Attachment II: Labor Allowances and Parts Ordering Information
Attachment III: Technical Information
Attachment IV: Low Volume Dealer Announcement Letter
Customer Notification Letter

QUESTIONS?

Claims Information:……..……....1-800-423-8851
Other (Dealer Only) Recall Questions:……..……...1-800-325-5621

Sincerely,



Ann O'Neill
Director
Vehicle Service and Programs

DEMONSTRATION / DELIVERY HOLD: Safety Recall 01S16
Certain 2001 Model Year Taurus/Sable – Front Seat Belt Buckle Replacement

OASIS

You must use OASIS to determine if a vehicle is eligible for this recall.

PLEASE NOTE

Correct all vehicles in stock before delivery. Federal law requires dealers to complete any outstanding safety recall service before a new vehicle is delivered to the buyer or lessee. Violation of this requirement by a dealer could result in a civil penalty of up to $5,000 per vehicle.

You must contact Program Headquarters at 1-800-248-0186 to arrange for parts if you have an involved vehicle in stock. When calling this number, identify Safety Recall 01S16 and have the VIN of the dealer stock vehicle to be serviced available.

PROMPTLY CORRECT

Promptly correct all affected vehicles on your dealer Recall/ONP Involved Unit Listings available on QCDealer.com or in the Ford Dealer Consolidated Communicator (FDCC). Also, correct other eligible vehicles, which are brought to your dealership.

DEALER-OWNER CONTACT

When you receive notification through MORS III, you should contact the owner and arrange for this service to be performed. Please note that Program Headquarters will advise owners that they will hear from you within the next two business days. For more information, see referenced copy of: "Low Volume Announcement Letter" dated May 10,1999.

Immediately contact any affected owner whose name is not on the VIN list but identified in OASIS. Give the owner a copy of the Owner Letter and schedule a service date.

REGIONAL CONTACT

Advise regional office if an owner:

- cannot be contacted.
- does not make a service date.

CLAIMS PREPARATION AND SUBMISSION

- Enter claims using DWE.
- Refer to ACESII manual for claims preparation and submission information.

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OWNER REFUNDS

Ford Motor Company will only refund owner-paid repairs made before the date of the Owner Letter (or after the date of the Owner Letter if an emergency repair was made away from the servicing dealer). Refer to ACESII manual for refund information.

RENTAL CARS

When replacement seat belt buckles are ordered for a sold unit, Ford will pay for a rental vehicle except for fuel, which will be at the owner's expense. Follow Extended Service Plan (ESP) guidelines for rental dollar amounts. Enter the word "RENTAL" plus the number of days the vehicle was used in the Miscellaneous Expense area of the recall claim.

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LABOR ALLOWANCES

Description	Labor Operation	Labor Time
Replace Both Seat Belt Buckles	01S16B	1.7 Hour
Administrative Allowance	Misc. Expense Code "ADMIN"	0.1 Hour

PARTS REQUIREMENTS

Parts Ordering Information

Parts will not be direct shipped for this program, and must be ordered according to the procedure established for "Low Volume Recalls". Order parts only for dealer stock units (Refer to Low Volume letter). Order your parts requirement through order processing channels as noted below:

All Order Types	First 60 days after launch	Call 1-800-248-0186
All Order Types	61 days after launch	Normal Order Process

Part Number	Description	Quantity
YF1Z-5461202-AAA	Med. Parchment (Right Hand)	1
YF1Z-5461203-AAA	Med. Parchment (Left Hand)	1
YF1Z-5461202-AAB	Med. Graphite (Right Hand)	1
YF1Z-5461203-AAB	Med. Graphite (Left Hand)	1
YF1Z-5461202-AAC	Midnight Black (Right Hand)	1
YF1Z-5461203-AAC	Midnight Black (Left Hand)	1

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ORDER INFORMATION DOR/COR

DOR/COR number 50237 identifies parts ordered for this campaign through Program Headquarters (1-800-248-0186).

DEALER PRICE

For latest prices, refer to:

- DOES II
- Updated Price Book

EXCESS STOCK RETURN

Excess stock returned for credit must have been purchased from Ford Customer Service Division in accordance with Policy Procedure Bulletin 4000.

Ford Motor Company

Ford Motor Company
P. O. Box 1904
Dearborn, Michigan 48121

April 2001

01S16

Mr. John Sample
123 Main Street
Anywhere, USA 12345

Your Vehicle Identification Number: 12345678901234567

This notice is sent to you in accordance with the requirements of the National Traffic and Motor Vehicle Safety Act.

Ford Motor Company has decided that a defect, which relates to motor vehicle safety, exists in certain 2001 model year Taurus and Sable vehicles.

What the safety issue is …

The front seat belt buckles on your vehicle may not fully eject the tongue from the buckle assembly when the release button is depressed slowly. This condition can also potentially result in a partial latch of the tongue in the buckle. If this occurs, the seat belt could provide less than the intended level of occupant restraint in the event of a vehicle crash.

What Ford Motor Company and your dealer will do ...

Ford Motor Company will repair your vehicle free of charge (parts and labor). Owners who are affected by this recall are requested to return their vehicle to their dealer for installation of replacement driver and right front passenger seat belt buckles.

How long will it take?

The time needed for this repair is less than one-half day. However, due to service scheduling issues, your dealer may need your vehicle for a longer period of time.

What we are asking you to do …

Call toll-free 1-800-248-0186 and inform the Ford representative that you wish to have your vehicle serviced under Safety Recall 01S16. Representatives are available 7:30AM to 7:30PM Monday through Friday, and 8:00AM to 3:00PM on Saturday (times are Eastern Time).

Please have this letter with you when you call. The Ford representative will ask for the serial number of your vehicle. The serial number is printed on the top of this letter.

Arrangements will be made with the dealership of your choice to have parts available. The dealership will call you to schedule an appointment. If you have not heard from your dealer within two

working days, call your dealer to request a service appointment. You need do nothing else except bring your vehicle to the dealership on the service date.

If you misplace this letter, your dealer will still do the work, free of charge.

Rental Vehicle…

Ford will pay for a rental vehicle except for fuel, which will be at the owner's expense, until repairs can be completed.

If you've already paid for this service …

If you paid to have this service done before the date of this letter, Ford is offering a full refund. For the refund, please give your paid original receipt to your dealer. To avoid delays, do not send receipts to Ford Motor Company.

If you've changed address or sold the vehicle …

Please fill out the enclosed prepaid postcard and mail it to us if you have changed address or sold the vehicle.

If you have Concerns …

If you have trouble getting your vehicle repaired promptly and without charge, please contact your dealership's Service Manager. If you still need assistance, please contact the Ford Motor Company Customer Relationship Center and one of our representatives will be happy to assist you:

CALL: (800) 392-3673
(800) 232-5952 (TDD for the Hearing Impaired)

Office Hours: (Eastern Standard Time)

Monday-Friday: 8am - 11pm
Saturday: 9am - 6pm

or you may contact us through the Internet at:
www.ownerconnection.com
Our current response time to Internet inquiries is three business days.

You also may send a complaint to the Administrator, National Highway Traffic Safety Administration, 400 Seventh Street, S. W., Washington, D. C. 20590 or call the toll free Auto Safety Hotline 1-888-327-4236 or 1-800-424-9393.

Quality Care service is there for you all year round.

QualityCare™ at your service

Quality Care is the commitment of Ford Motor Company and its dealerships to provide you with a superior service and ownership experience. While we regret the inconvenience caused by this program, we stand committed with our dealers to assist you with all of your automotive service needs. With our nationwide dealer network, we're here to ensure you receive Quality Care service so that your vehicle maintains peak performance throughout your ownership experience.

We pride ourselves on becoming the world's leading Consumer Company for automotive products and services. Thank you for your attention to this important matter.

Sincerely,



Ann O'Neill
Director
Vehicle Service and Programs